



# Maryland State Board of Elections

## State Administrator's Report

March 26, 2026

### Important Announcements and Meetings

Gambling on elections is illegal in Maryland. A person may not make a bet or wager on election results. Despite this prohibition, some platforms, known as prediction markets, are structured differently from traditional gambling sites and are framed as “forecasting” rather than betting. These platforms allow users to trade contracts based on the outcomes of events, including elections. It is important for Maryland residents to understand that even though such platforms are accessible online, participation may still conflict with state law. Engaging in election-related wagering within the State could expose individuals to legal penalties. So just don't do it.

On March 23-25, Election Systems & Software (ES&S) provided demonstrations of the new voting system that is being considered beginning in the 2028 election cycle. This solution was selected through the competitive bid and state procurement process. This is a requirement as part of the state voting system certification process and highlighted the accessible ballot marking device and precinct based tabulator. The demonstration allowed the public to ask questions and submit comments regarding the proposed voting system's functionality, ease of use, and overall experience. Information on this event was shared on social media, on our website and in a recent press release. Currently, the SBE team is reviewing the questions and comments that were submitted.

In preparation of the 2026 Election, we have reviewed and audited the Official Turnout Statistics Reports. During this audit of data query, it was discovered that since 2016, the reports did not have all of the relevant election information. We have worked diligently to recompile the Official Turnout Statistics Reports. Updated reports for the 2024 election cycle will be available on our website by March 26, 2026, along with user guides on how to read and interpret the data. SBE will continue to work on updating Official Turnout Statistics Reports from prior election cycles by the end of May.

### Legislation

As of March 24, 2026, this is the status of legislation that we are monitoring since crossover occurred on March 23, 2026. For bills that have passed through one chamber, they will be heard in the opposite chamber and considered before Sine Die on April 13. For bills that have crossfiles, the crossfile will be heard in the opposite chamber and considered before Sine Die as well.

| Bill Number   | Subject                                                                | Status                                |
|---------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|
| HB 156/SB 132 | Unaffiliated Voters Choosing Party and Voting in Primaries             | Passed House; Failed in Senate        |
| HB 182/SB 237 | Presidential Electors - Selection and Voting                           | Crossfiles passed in House and Senate |
| HB 260/SB 11  | Earlier Distributions from Fair Campaign Financing Fund (Departmental) | Crossfiles passed in House and Senate |



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|                |                                                                                                             |                                          |
|----------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------|
| HB 263/SB 100  | Early Voting Bus Stops (Departmental)                                                                       | Crossfiles passed in House and Senate    |
| HB 333         | Political Party Central Committee Procedures - General Assembly Vacancy                                     | Passed House                             |
| HB 357         | Municipal Election Dates Reporting                                                                          | Passed House                             |
| HB 621/SB 443  | Local Boards of Election - Counsel Qualifications                                                           | Crossfiles passed in House and Senate    |
| HB 855/SB 758  | Common Ownership Communities - Display Period for Campaign Signs                                            | Crossfiles passed in House and Senate    |
| HB 1001/SB 670 | Local Board of Elections Employees - Authority at Polling Places                                            | Crossfiles passed in House and Senate    |
| SB 4/HB 514    | Keeping Charities Nonpartisan Act                                                                           | Special order adopted until next session |
| SB 5/HB 50     | Special Election to Fill Vacancy                                                                            | Passed Senate                            |
| SB 8/HB 184    | Criminal Identity Fraud/Deepfakes                                                                           | Passed Senate                            |
| SB 29/HB 44    | Plain Language in Petitions and Ballot Questions                                                            | Passed Senate                            |
| SB 40/HB 41    | Baltimore County Board of Education - Alteration of Districts and Redistricting Process                     | Passed Senate                            |
| SB 65/HB 157   | Exploratory Committees - Campaign Finance Rules                                                             | Passed Senate                            |
| SB 91/HB 265   | ACP Enrollee Management (Departmental)                                                                      | Crossfiles passed in House and Senate    |
| SB 141/HB 145  | Election Misinformation, Disinformation, Deepfakes                                                          | Passed Senate                            |
| SB 153/HB 267  | Oversight and Control of Campaign Finance Funds (Departmental)                                              | Passed Senate                            |
| SB 241/HB 115  | Automatic Restoration of Voting Rights on Release from Incarceration                                        | Crossfiles passed in House and Senate    |
| SB 255/HB 350  | Voting Rights Act - Counties and Municipal Corporations                                                     | Passed Senate                            |
| SB 632         | State Elected Officials - Protection of Personal Information                                                | Passed Senate                            |
| SB 697         | Actions to Influence an Election - Social Media Platform Algorithms and Bots Purchased by Foreign Nationals | Passed Senate                            |
| SB 848/HB 1448 | Information on Municipal Candidates and Voting                                                              | Crossfiles passed in House and Senate    |



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### **Candidacy and Campaign Finance (CCF) Division**

Between February 12 and March 16, 2026, 457 new committees were established.

#### 2026 Gubernatorial Elections

SBE has filed 536 candidates for the 2026 Primary Election. The candidate filing deadline was February 24, 2026, at 9:00 PM.

Every candidate who filed in 2025 had to file another financial disclosure statement in 2026 in order to appear on the ballot. SBE contacted candidates about these requirements multiple times via calls and emails over the last few weeks. The candidates had until the withdrawal deadline, March 6, 2026 at 11:59 PM to file a current financial disclosure statement. Four candidates were disqualified from the Primary ballot for not filing their 2025 financial disclosure statements.

#### MD CRIS

The next report in the MD CRIS system will be the Spring Report, due on Tuesday, April 21, at 11:59 PM. This report is only required for new committees established that were not required to file the 2026 Annual Report.

#### Website Activity

In February 2026, the MD Campaign Reporting Information System (MD CRIS) website was visited by 30,253 individuals for an average of 657.67 per day. Additionally, it had 4,289,870 hits. Each viewer looked at an average of approximately 141.34 page views per day. The Business Contribution Disclosure System (BCDS) website was visited by 11,251 individuals for an average of 387.97 per day. Additionally, it had 2,815,666 hits. Each viewer looked at an average of approximately 249.58 page views per day.

#### Public Financing (PF)

Currently, there are 70 active public financed (PF) committees. As of March 17, 28 public financed candidates are Certified/Qualified. So far, Anne Arundel County has distributed \$225,331.34, Baltimore County has distributed \$192,445.01, Howard County has distributed \$801,299.25, and Montgomery County has distributed \$1,817,783.45 in public funds to Certified/Qualified candidates.

Currently, there is \$10,674,078.36 in the State Fair Campaign Fund. The deadline to be certified to receive matching funds for the Primary Election was on February 24, 2026.

### **Enforcement**

Listed below are the civil penalties paid in February 2025. The total amount collected is \$1,850:

- a. Friends of Chuck Borges - \$50 - Failure to include authority line or authority line is insufficient.
- b. Committee to Elect Joshua Kyte - \$50 - Failure to include authority line or authority line is insufficient.



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- c. Kitchin, James Citizens For - \$500 - Failure to include authority line or authority line is insufficient.
- d. Kitchin, James Citizens For - \$1,000 - Failure to include authority line or authority line is insufficient.
- e. Bobby LaPin for Baltimore - \$250 - Failure to include authority line or authority line is insufficient.

### **Communications**

The SBE Official Voter Resource app is live on the Google Play Store. It is pending review by Apple and will be available soon!

Social Media presence remains a priority to ensure voters know their election officials are their trusted sources for election information.

We have begun an aggressive voter outreach campaign focusing on voter education. The campaign includes a landing page that allows people to upload the election calendar to an individual's phone and provides information on how to register to vote, become an election judge and methods of voting. There will continue to be paid outreach focusing on election judge recruitment and voter education leading up to the 2026 Primary and General elections. There will also be resources provided to local boards for the use of organic social media content to supplement the outreach campaign. Internally, we will utilize their own organic social media content to target mis/disinformation through voter education materials and videos.

Visit our 2026 Primary landing page at [vote.md.gov/vote2026](https://vote.md.gov/vote2026).

### Social Media Highlights

So far in 2026, we have seen a large increase in social media engagement. We have gained 558 new Facebook followers and 343 new Instagram followers. Our Instagram posts have reached almost 600 interactions, while our Facebook page has seen almost 1.3M interactions.

One organic Facebook post featuring Election Dates was viewed over 200,000 times, liked by almost 3,000 people, and shared over 1,000 times.

We have also officially hit 2k followers on Instagram!

Our ads have also been drawing in a noteworthy number of engagements. The current ads we have running feature information encouraging voters to prepare for the 2026 Primary Election.

### Media Coverage Highlights

In the week of March 16, the State Board of Elections was highlighted in the media 19 times over various platforms.



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- Online: 10
- TV: 5
- Radio: 3
- Print: 1

This coverage is estimated to have a potential audience reach of 8,416,347 over 29 days.

Topics covered included the upcoming public demo for the voting system under consideration for the 2028 election cycle, information on candidates in the upcoming election, and how to vote in Maryland.

### **Election Management & Compliance**

#### Correctional Facility Voting

We will begin attending Department of Public Safety and Correctional Services (DPSCS) resource fairs to conduct voter outreach this month. The first event is a Re-entry Resources Fair at the Baltimore War Memorial building on 3/25.

#### Contractual Staffing for Election

The SBE Election Judge Train-The-Trainer program is underway and nearing completion. Trainers that have successfully completed the program are being deployed to their assigned assignments based on local board training schedules.

LBE Technicians & Support Tech's will begin SBE training and LBE deployments on April 20th. These personnel will provide technical onsite support through the primary election.

#### Transportation for Election

Logistics meetings started with local boards on 3/16/26. The transportation team will begin the process of capturing key information during the meetings. This information is used to create routing for voting equipment from local board warehouses to voting locations.

Ballot drop box routing has been created and approved for the primary election. Drop box deliveries will take place the week of May 4th. All drop boxes across the state will be placed at their assigned locations by Friday May 8th.

#### Language Assistance Implementation:

Anne Arundel County, Baltimore City, Baltimore County, Montgomery County, and Prince George's County will provide language assistance in 2026 under the new state law. These counties will have signage and an interpretation service, Language Line Solutions, available at polling places, and translated voter registration and absentee ballot applications and voter guides posted to their websites. The counties are also making efforts to recruit bilingual Election Judges. If LBEs want to provide additional documents or help in more languages, they will submit a request using a form prescribed by SBE.



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### Election Judges

All election judge-facing manuals and forms have been reviewed and revised. We continue to track election judge recruitment, pay rates, and training schedules in preparation for the 2026 Gubernatorial Primary. To this date, we have received over 1300 responses just through our online interest application. We are preparing to visit and evaluate election judge training at 12 local boards of elections, including those jurisdictions that were not reviewed in the previous election cycle.

### **Information Systems & Technology**

#### Applications

MDVOTERS will deploy a small release on March 20th to address how ballots are received within the system. Therefore, the MDVOTERS 10.6 release has been scheduled for April 17, 2026. This will be the final release prior to the primary election and will focus on web delivery reporting enhancements and cure letter updates.

### **Information Security**

#### Built In Security

SBE Security has been conducting security best practice and relevancy reviews on SBE RFPs to ensure that security requirements are incorporated early in the procurement process and to avoid the common "security after the fact" approach.

### **Mail-In Voting (MIV)**

#### Permanent Mail-in Confirmation Notices:

Maryland law requires that SBE send a confirmation to voters on the permanent mail-in list each election year to confirm their status as mail-in voters, as well as their address, ballot-delivery method, and party affiliation. SBE sent the notices on March 17, 2026 via the method requested by the voter: mail, text, or email. In total, SBE sent 273,819 emails, 129,381 text messages and 160,816 mailers.

#### Postmarking

SBE is communicating to voters the importance of returning mail-in ballots so they are received timely, including 1) encouraging voters not to wait until the last minute to return their ballot, 2) the option to request manual postmarks at post office, and 3) the availability of drop boxes which are available until 8pm on election day.

#### Overseas postal service interruptions

The MIV team is investigating options to remind Maryland voters who are overseas, and have requested MIBs-via-postal service, about the MIB-via-web delivery option.



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### Personnel Management

HR has processed 13 recruitments since February for local boards of elections and the State Board of Elections. It is expected to have frequent recruitments for the LBEs as they prepare for the upcoming election. Wicomico and Worcester Counties are interviewing to fill both of their Deputy Director positions. We expect this to continue as the LBE's prepare to staff for the upcoming election.

We would like to welcome Anna Johnson, Cecelia Assam and Samuel Heller to SBE. Anna and Cecelia are working in election reform and customer service. Samuel is now part of the Voter Registration Division.

We would like to welcome Sharonda Munson as the new Deputy Director in Charles County. Sharonda has 8 years experience at the Charles County office.

SBE is recruiting for an Assistant Deputy of Candidate and Project Management Operations.

### Procurement

#### *Active Procurements*

*The New Voting System (NVS):* RFP D38B5600001 was published on June 27, 2025. On September 5, 2025 SBE received 4 offers in response to the solicitation. One Offeror withdrew their proposal. The RFP is planned for deployment in the 2028 election. SBE sent an intent to award on February 3, 2026 to the Offeror unanimously selected by the evaluation committee as the top choice for Maryland. All debriefings have concluded and SBE received no protests of our award decision. The State certification process is currently underway and SBE is targeting one of the two June BPW meetings for award approval.

*Managed Security Services: RFP D38B6600005-* The MSS RFP for a managed security services provider was approved by DoIT on March 6, 2026 and is currently with the Office of State Procurement for review. The Office of State Procurement is the final review stage before approval to publish the RFP. The purpose of this solicitation is to procure a security contract that strengthens the agency's cybersecurity operations, engineering capabilities, and enterprise risk management. The selected contractor will provide managed security operations, specialized engineering expertise, and strategic advisory services to support the continued maturation of the agency's Cyber Security Division.

*MDVOTERS V Data Center: RFP D38B6600007-* The MDVOTERS V hosting services RFP was submitted to DoIT for review on March 12, 2026. The purpose of this contract is for Data Center (DC) hosting services, including hardware for several election systems, network administration, and DC migration/relocation services, and a managed services provider for the data centers. The primary DC is also referred to as the Voter Registration Operations Center (VROC) throughout this document.



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Additionally requirements include the management and operations of the Continuity of Operations Center (COOP) data center.

*Correctional Facility Mailers:* The deadline for bids for this was March 12, 2026 and bids are currently under review.

*Temporary Wheelchair Ramps:* SBE received two bids in response to this solicitation on March 5th. An award to AmRamp was made. The temporary wheelchair ramps are for polling places Statewide for the Primary and General Elections.

### *Recent Awards*

*Social Media Monitoring:* SBE has awarded our social media monitoring contract under which the selected contractor will detect, alert, and respond to social media and digital attack surface threats related to SBE and the State of Maryland Elections. The selected vendor is Media Share Solutions and the contract started on March 9, 2026.

*Other supply orders* made through the preferred provider Maryland Correctional Enterprises "MCE" including: I Voted Stickers, Orange Provisional Bags, Yellow Absentee Bags, Voter Update Forms, Voter Assistance Cards, Need Assistance Stickers, Voter Authority Cards

### *Requests for Information*

*Automated Ballot Tabulation Audit Contract:* An RFI for information on additional vendor options for the Clear Ballot contract to determine if this is still a sole source or if other vendors have entered the marketplace was posted on eMMA on January 15, 2026. SBE received four responses and they are under review to determine if any of the respondents other than Clear Ballot Group have the capability to meet our requirements.

## **Voter Registration & Audits**

### Voter Registration

The Maryland Health Benefits Exchange (MHBE) erroneously informed SBE that certain individuals were eligible to vote in Maryland or that they had completed their application to register to vote. We are correcting this clerical error with the individuals and MHBE. This is an ongoing process; there are no further details at this time.

### Internal Audits

Monthly audits of voter registration data continue to verify compliance with federal and state laws governing voter registration. This month, work has focused on preparing updates to the Election Director Evaluation and Comprehensive Audit for the 2026 election cycle. Additionally, fuzzy matching for DHMH and duplicate voters were prepared and sent to the LBEs for processing.



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The ERIC Cross-State Voter Participation Project (VPP) has concluded data collection from all member states. We continue to receive requests for additional data periodically and address those when received. This was a major collaborative effort across ERIC member states.

### Non-Citizens

Non-citizen referrals from jury notifications are, in general, sent to the State Prosecutor's office on a quarterly basis. Self-reports from non-citizens are referred to the State Prosecutor's office on a more frequent basis (weekly to monthly).

The following summarizes relevant activity from February through mid-March:

Submitted to the Office of the State Prosecutor - 4

Removal of non-citizens - 4

Removal of non-citizens who voted - 1

Removal of non-citizens who voted multiple times - 0

Non-citizens reported by Immigration & Customs Enforcement - 0

Change in status from Office of the State Prosecutor - 0

### Registration & Election Management Database (MDVOTERS)

ERIC Reports for February were received.

Deceased: 396

In State Duplicates: 74

The current total active registered voters as of March 16, 2026 was 4,307,006.

### Motor Vehicle Administration (MVA) Transactions

During February 2026, MVA collected the following voter registration transactions:

New Registration - 7,851

Residential Address Changes - 15,882

Last Name Changes - 2,499

Political Party - 5,661

Last 13 Months of MVA Transactions - Chart:

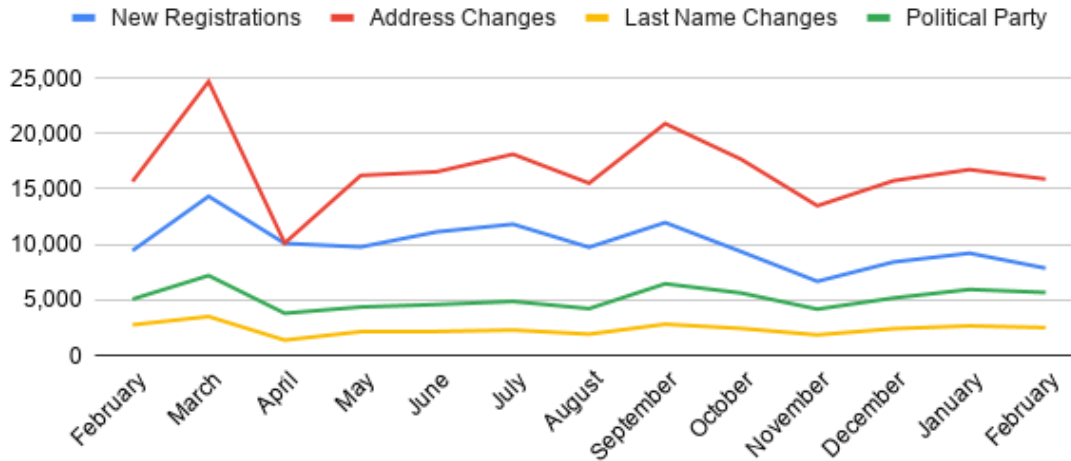


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### MVA Transactions February 2025 to February 2026



#### MVA Transactions - Monthly Changes:

|                                   | New Registrations | Address Changes | Last Name | Political Party |
|-----------------------------------|-------------------|-----------------|-----------|-----------------|
| <b>Jan-2026</b>                   |                   |                 |           |                 |
| Month-to-Month - Change           | 9.4%              | 6.4%            | 10.5%     | 14.9%           |
| Same Month - Previous Year Change | -15.2%            | -17.7%          | -63.2%    | 62.1%           |
| Same Month - 2 Years Ago Change   | 4.8%              | -29.2%          | -24.0%    | 8.3%            |
| <b>Feb-2026</b>                   |                   |                 |           |                 |
| Month-to-Month - Change           | -14.7%            | -5.1%           | -5.7%     | -4.6%           |
| Same Month - Previous Year Change | -16.8%            | 1.4%            | -9.1%     | 11.9%           |
| Same Month - 2 Years Ago Change   | -25.6%            | -2.3%           | -13.1%    | -10.8%          |

#### MSR- Removals



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### Maryland Board of Elections Voter Registration Activity Report January 2026

| REMOVALS                 |       |       |     |     |       |     |      |     |        |
|--------------------------|-------|-------|-----|-----|-------|-----|------|-----|--------|
|                          | DEM   | REP   | GRN | WCP | UNA   | OTH | UNAF | OTH | TOTAL  |
| BOARD ACTION             | 0     | 0     | 0   | 0   | 0     | 0   |      |     | 0      |
| CONFIRMATION MAIL        | 28    | 9     | 0   | 0   | 8     | 1   |      |     | 46     |
| COUNTY TRANSFER - OUT    | 3265  | 1143  | 11  | 8   | 1504  | 117 |      |     | 6,048  |
| CRIMINAL CONVICTION      | 1     | 0     | 0   | 0   | 1     | 0   |      |     | 2      |
| DEATH NOTICE             | 1809  | 1009  | 1   | 4   | 438   | 35  |      |     | 3,296  |
| DUPLICATE                | 76    | 16    | 0   | 0   | 30    | 5   |      |     | 127    |
| MAIL VERIFICATION (NVRA) | 523   | 294   | 3   | 1   | 369   | 28  |      |     | 1,218  |
| MENTAL INCOMPETENCY      | 0     | 1     | 0   | 0   | 0     | 0   |      |     | 1      |
| MOVED OUT OF STATE       | 298   | 207   | 1   | 1   | 148   | 11  |      |     | 666    |
| OTHER                    | 28    | 9     | 1   | 0   | 31    | 5   |      |     | 74     |
| VOTER REQUEST            | 59    | 38    | 1   | 0   | 53    | 3   |      |     | 154    |
|                          |       |       |     |     |       |     |      |     |        |
|                          |       |       |     |     |       |     |      |     |        |
|                          |       |       |     |     |       |     |      |     |        |
|                          |       |       |     |     |       |     |      |     |        |
|                          |       |       |     |     |       |     |      |     |        |
| TOTAL                    | 6,087 | 2,726 | 18  | 14  | 2,582 | 205 |      | 0   | 11,632 |

### Exercise of Delegated Duties

We will use this section of the State Administrator's Report to report when we have exercised duties assigned to the State Board of Elections but delegated to the State Administrator and staff.

Since the last State Administrator's Report:

  X   No delegated duties were exercised.

       The following delegated duties were exercised: